

POLYGENETIC CONGLOMERATE

A coarse-grained sedimentary rock, polygenetic conglomerate has many different, rounded rock and mineral fragments in a finer grained matrix.

*rounded
quartz pebble*

*sandstone
matrix*

QUARTZ CONGLOMERATE

Varying in colour, this rock typically has dirty white, pebble-sized, rounded quartz fragments set in a finer, darker matrix.

*iron oxide
gives red colour*

RED CHALK

CHALK

Pure calcite, chalk is very fine-grained and powdery. It is composed of minute fossilized organisms, including coccoliths and radiolarians.

WHITE CHALK

MARL

Intermediate between clay and limestone, marl is a fine-grained, calcite-rich, layered rock. Chlorite and glauconite can give it a green colouring.

MUDSTONE

Composed of clay, with fine-grained quartz and feldspars, mudstone lacks the bedding found in shale.

BRECCIA

Containing large, angular fragments of rocks and minerals set in a finer matrix of sand or silt, breccia rarely forms in layers.

SILTSTONE

This dark-coloured rock comprises particles, mainly of quartz, which are smaller than fine sand but larger than clay grains. It can also contain organic material and calcite.

CHERT

A very fine-grained form of silica, chert occurs as bands and nodules in rocks such as limestone. It is usually grey coloured.

FLINT

Usually found as nodules in chalk, flint is very hard, black, compact silica. It breaks leaving sharp, curved edges.